Hare Krishna Golden Temple

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

HELICOPTER YATRA · AARTI AT THE HOLY CAVE

Vaishno Devi
Helicopter Yatra

with ISKCON Hare Krishna Devotees







13 – 16 March 2027

3 Nights / 4 Days

Jammu · Katra · Vaishno Devi · Katra · Jammu

Registrations close 25 December 2026 · limited helicopter seats

- Helicopter both ways
- Aarti at the Holy Cave
- Night at Bhawan
- Banganga darshan
- Kirtan & sthala purana
- Senior-friendly

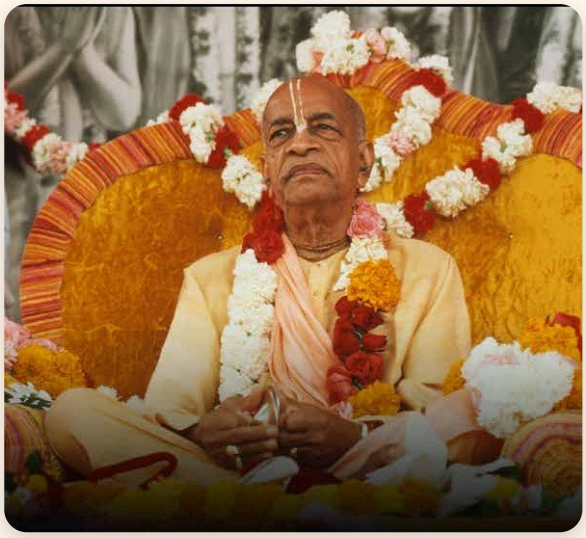
Book Now → **95053 88886**

www.punyakshetras.com
www.hkmhyderabad.org

Warm greetings *from Punya Kshetras*

Take Mother Vaishno Devi's darshan the gentle way. A short helicopter flight from Katra to Sanjichhat replaces the 13 km climb, so yatris of every age can reach the Holy Cave, stay overnight at Bhawan, and sit before Mata Rani for both the Evening and Morning Aarti at the main temple, which we arrange for the group. The yatra begins with the ancient temples of Jammu and ends with Banganga and Darshani Deodi at Katra, all in the association of ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees.

Punya Kshetras is the pilgrimage service of Hare Krishna Golden Temple, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad. Every yatra is led by devotees, with kirtan, japa and the glories of each holy place narrated along the way, sattvic food, careful planning and special attention to elders.



His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Srila Prabhupada,
Founder-Acharya of ISKCON

> *The holy places all over the earth are meant for purifying the polluted consciousness of the human being by an atmosphere surcharged with the presence of the Lord's unalloyed devotees. If anyone visits a holy place, he must search out the pure devotees residing in such holy places, take lessons from them, try to apply such instructions in practical life and thus gradually prepare oneself for moksha.*
>
> Srila Prabhupada · Srimad Bhagavatam 1.13.10, Purport

YATRA HIGHLIGHTS

- Helicopter both ways, Katra ⇄ Sanjichhat
- Aarti at the Holy Cave, arranged for you
- More time before Mata Rani; three Pindis
- Night at Bhawan for both Aartis
- Bhairon Baba Temple by ropeway
- Banganga darshan & Darshani Deodi
- Raghunath & Ranbireshwar, Jammu
- Kirtan, bhajans & sthala purana daily

OVERNIGHT STAYS

2 Nights — JAMMU

1 Night — BHAWAN

YOUR DEPARTURE

Your yatra, 13–16 March 2027, falls in a lovely window: pleasant days in Jammu and cool nights at Bhawan. Carry a shawl for the night at Bhawan.

The route *step by step*

4	3	2	136	6
DAYS	NIGHTS	HELICOPTER RIDES	KM BY ROAD	TEMPLES & SHRINES

1 Jammu
Arrival · Raghunath · Ranbireshwar

CAR 50 km

2 Katra
RFID registration · helipad

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

3 Sanjichhat
Helipad

BATTERY CAR 2.5 km

4 Bhawan
Holy Cave · Aarti · night stay

ROPEWAY 3 min

5 Bhairon Temple
Completes the yatra

continues → **Walk** ~3 km

6 Sanjichhat
Return flight

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

7 Katra
Banganga · Darshani Deodi · market

CAR 50 km

8 Jammu
Night stay

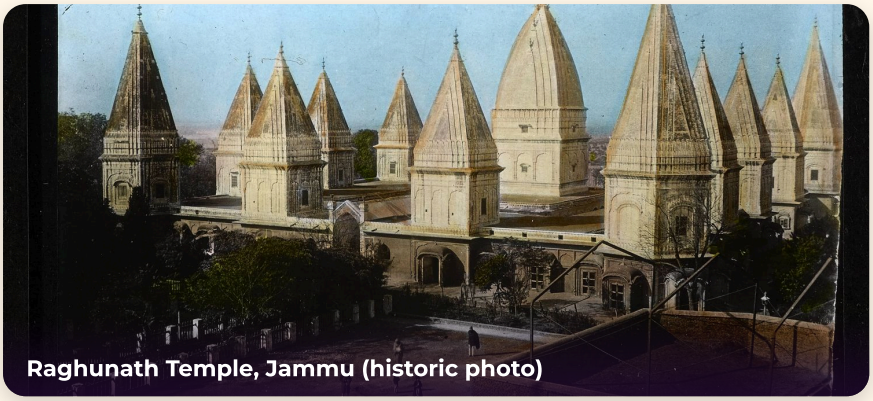
CAR 7 km

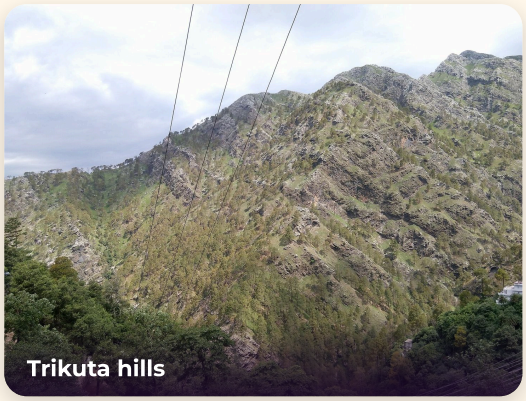
9 Jammu Airport
Return flights after 2 pm


Helicopter to Sanjichhat


Bhawan on the Trikuta


Banganga, Katra


Raghunath Temple, Jammu (historic photo)


Trikuta hills

DAY 01
Sat 13 Mar

Jammu Arrival – Raghunath & Ranbireshwar Temples

Overnight: **Jammu**

Arrive at Jammu, the City of Temples, by 2 pm. After check-in and a late lunch at the hotel, take darshan at Sri Raghunath Temple and Ranbireshwar Temple, then browse Raghunath Bazaar for dry fruits and local crafts before returning to the hotel for kirtan and dinner.

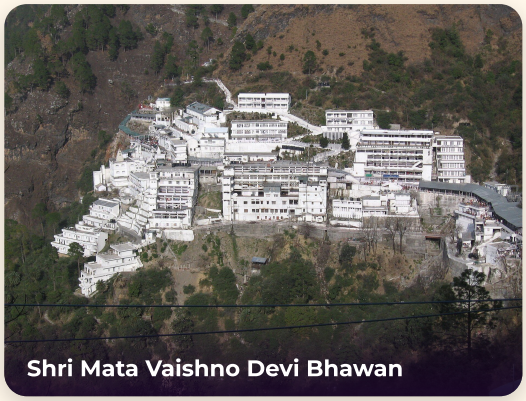
DID YOU KNOW?

Raghunath Temple, begun by Maharaja Gulab Singh in 1835 and completed by Maharaja Ranbir Singh in 1860, is dedicated to Lord Rama and houses a large collection of saligrama shilas. Ranbireshwar Temple is known for its tall Shiva lingam and twelve crystal lingams.

14:00 – 14:30	ARRIVAL	**Jammu Airport (IXJ)** · Meet our representative, garland welcome, load luggage, headcount	
14:30 – 14:50	CAR	**Jammu Airport → Hotel, Jammu** · Transfer to the hotel	7 km
14:50 – 15:15	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-in, freshen up	
15:15 – 15:50	LUNCH	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Lunch	
15:50 – 16:05	CAR	**Hotel, Jammu → Raghunath Temple** · Drive to the old-city temple complex	5 km
16:05 – 16:45	DARSHAN	**Raghunath Temple** · Darshan of Sri Rama, Sita and Lakshmana; galleries of saligramas; group kirtan	
16:45 – 16:55	CAR	**Raghunath Temple → Ranbireshwar Temple** · Short hop	1 km
16:55 – 17:30	DARSHAN	**Ranbireshwar Temple** · Darshan of the 7.5 ft Shiva lingam and crystal lingams	
17:30 – 17:40	CAR	**Ranbireshwar Temple → Raghunath Bazaar** · Short hop to the old-city market	1 km
17:40 – 18:40	SHOPPING	**Raghunath Bazaar, Jammu** · Dry fruits, Kalari cheese, Dogra handicrafts	
18:40 – 19:00	CAR	**Raghunath Bazaar → Hotel, Jammu** · Return to the hotel	5 km
19:00 – 20:15	REST	**Hotel, Jammu** · Rest, kirtan; Day 2 briefing (photo ID, small bag for Bhawan; main luggage stays at this hotel)	
20:15 – 21:15	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Dinner	

Saturday 13 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Sanjichhat Helipad


Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan

DAY 02
Sun 14 Mar

Katra – Helicopter to Vaishno Devi Bhawan

Overnight: **Bhawan**

Drive to Katra at the foot of the Trikuta mountain, collect your RFID Yatra card and board the helicopter to Sanjichhat. A 2.5 km battery-car ride brings you to Bhawan. After rest and kirtan, enter the Holy Cave for darshan of the three Pindis and sit before Mata Rani for the Evening Aarti at the main temple, which we arrange for the group.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

In the Holy Cave the Mother is worshipped in the form of three natural rock Pindis, representing Maha Kali, Maha Lakshmi and Maha Saraswati. The shrine sits at about 5,200 ft on the Trikuta mountain.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Breakfast	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-out with a small bag; main luggage stays at the Jammu hotel for Day 3	
09:00 – 10:30	CAR	**Hotel, Jammu → Katra** · Drive via the Jammu–Katra highway; tea stop en route	50 km
10:30 – 11:00	REGISTRATION	**Yatra Registration Counter, Katra** · RFID Yatra cards for every yatri (carry original photo ID)	
11:00 – 11:10	CAR	**Katra town → Katra Helipad** · Drive to the helipad	2 km
11:10 – 12:15	REPORTING	**Katra Helipad** · Report for the allotted slot: ticket and ID check, baggage weighing, security	
12:15 – 12:25	HELICOPTER	**Katra Helipad → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Helicopter flight, about 5–8 minutes	
12:25 – 13:00	BATTERY CAR	**Sanjichhat Helipad → Bhawan** · 2.5 km to Bhawan by battery car	
13:00 – 13:30	HALT	**Bhawan** · Check-in at Bhawan accommodation; cloak room	
13:30 – 14:15	LUNCH	**Restaurant, Bhawan** · Lunch	
14:15 – 16:30	REST	**Bhawan** · Rest, japa, group kirtan	
16:30 – 18:00	DARSHAN	**Holy Cave, Bhawan** · Darshan of the three Pindis (Maha Kali, Maha Lakshmi, Maha Saraswati)	
18:00 – 19:30	AARTI	**Bhawan** · Evening Atka Aarti at the Holy Cave (main temple) – Aarti passes arranged by the organisers so yatris sit before Mata Rani for the full Aarti	
19:30 – 20:30	DINNER	**Restaurant, Bhawan** · Dinner	

Sunday 14 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Ropeway to Bhairon Ghati


Banganga, Katra

DAY 03 Mon 15 Mar

Morning Aarti – Bhairon Temple – Katra – Jammu

Overnight: **Jammu**

Rise early to sit before Mata Rani for the Morning Aarti at the Holy Cave, arranged for our group, then take the ropeway to Bhairon Baba Temple. Walk down to Sanjichhat for the return flight to Katra. After lunch, take darshan at sacred Banganga and visit Darshani Deodi, the traditional gateway of the yatra, and Katra's market, then drive back to Jammu for the night at the same hotel as Day 1.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

Tradition holds that the yatra is complete only after darshan at Bhairon Baba Temple. At Banganga, the Mother is believed to have shot an arrow into the earth to bring forth water.

04:30 – 05:30	HALT	**Bhawan** · Wake-up, bath, get ready	
05:30 – 07:00	AARTI	**Bhawan** · Morning Atka Aarti at the Holy Cave (main temple) – arranged by the organisers; more time before Mata Rani	
07:00 – 07:30	REST	**Bhawan** · Rest, pack small bag	
07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Restaurant, Bhawan** · Breakfast	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Bhawan** · Check-out, collect cloak-room items	
09:00 – 09:15	WALK	**Bhawan → Bhawan ropeway station** · Short walk (~300 m) to the ropeway	
09:15 – 09:35	ROPEWAY	**Bhawan ropeway station → Bhairon Ghati** · Ropeway ride, about 3 minutes plus queue	
09:35 – 10:15	DARSHAN	**Bhairon Baba Temple** · Darshan of Bhairon Baba – completes the yatra	
10:15 – 11:15	WALK	**Bhairon Temple → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Downhill track ~3 km to the helipad (escorts assist seniors)	
11:15 – 12:15	REPORTING	**Sanjichhat Helipad** · Report for the return slot	
12:15 – 12:25	HELICOPTER	**Sanjichhat Helipad → Katra Helipad** · Return flight, about 5–8 minutes	
12:25 – 12:40	CAR	**Katra Helipad → Pooja Vaishno Dhaba, Katra** · Pick-up at the helipad	2 km
12:40 – 13:30	LUNCH	**Pooja Vaishno Dhaba, Katra** · Lunch (pure veg; backup Madhuban Saattvik Restaurant)	
13:30 – 13:45	CAR	**Katra → Banganga** · Drive to Banganga	3 km
13:45 – 14:30	DARSHAN	**Banganga** · Darshan at Banganga, the holy stream the Mother brought forth with an arrow; sprinkle the sacred water	
14:30 – 14:40	CAR	**Banganga → Darshani Deodi** · Short hop	1 km
14:40 – 15:10	DARSHAN	**Darshani Deodi** · Traditional gateway of the yatra; group photo	
15:10 – 15:25	CAR	**Darshani Deodi → Katra Main Bazaar** · Drive to the market	2 km
15:25 – 16:30	SHOPPING	**Katra Main Bazaar** · Prasad, chunri, dry fruits, walnut and handicrafts	
16:30 – 18:00	CAR	**Katra → Hotel, Jammu** · Drive back to Jammu	50 km
18:00 – 18:30	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-in (same hotel as Day 1), collect main luggage	
18:30 – 20:00	REST	**Hotel, Jammu** · Rest, kirtan; Day 4 briefing	
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Dinner	

Monday 15 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.



Katra welcome gate


Bhawan complex

DAY 04
Tue 16 Mar

Jammu – Departure

Departure · **Jai Mata Di!**

After breakfast at the Jammu hotel, check out and leave at 9 am for Jammu Airport, a short 7 km drive, for return flights after 2 pm, carrying the blessings of Mother Vaishno Devi. Jai Mata Di!

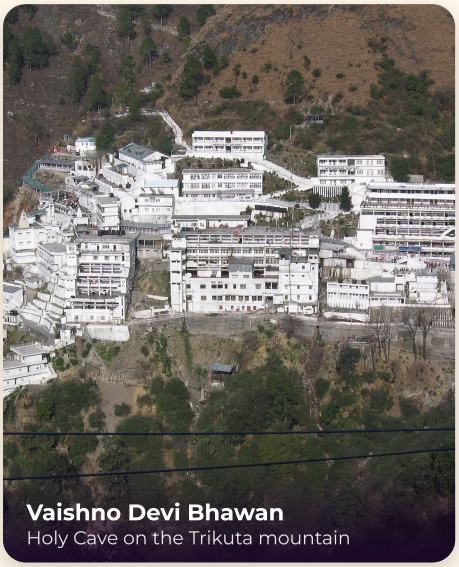
SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

The Trikuta mountain, home of Mother Vaishno Devi, is visible from the Jammu plains on a clear day; pilgrims leave with a parting prayer to return for her darshan again.

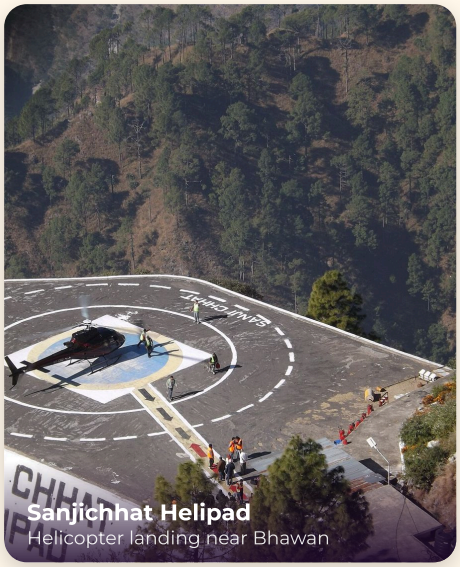
07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Breakfast	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-out, load luggage; packed lunch for the journey	
09:00 – 09:20	CAR	**Hotel, Jammu → Jammu Airport** · Drive to the airport	7 km
09:20 – 09:45	DEPARTURE	**Jammu Airport** · Farewell – Jai Mata Di! (return flights after 14:00)	

Tuesday 16 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.

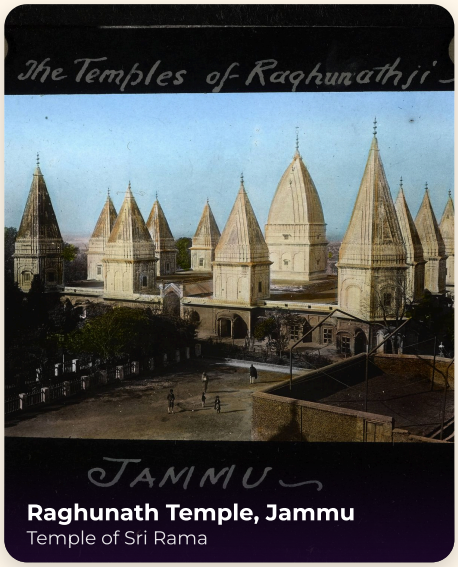
Sacred places *on this yatra*



Vaishno Devi Bhawan
Holy Cave on the Trikuta mountain



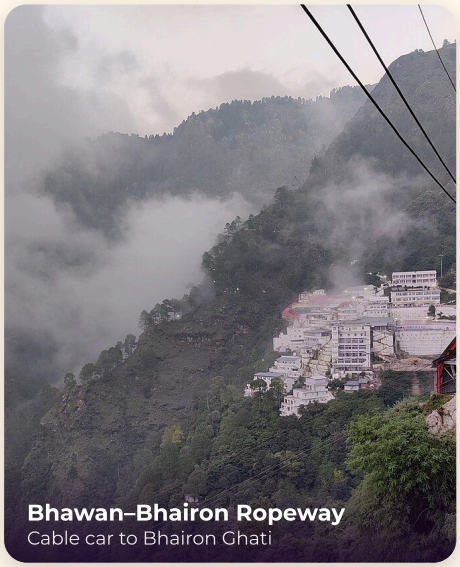
Sanjichhat Helipad
Helicopter landing near Bhawan



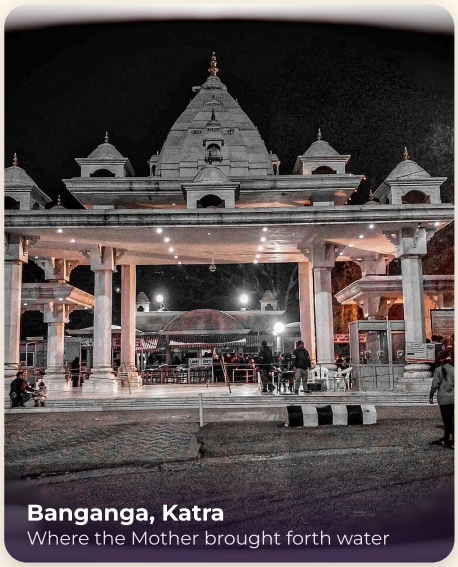
Raghunath Temple, Jammu
Temple of Sri Rama



Katra
Base town of the yatra



Bhawan–Bhairon Ropeway
Cable car to Bhairon Ghati



Banganga, Katra
Where the Mother brought forth water

PACKAGE INCLUDES

- Accommodation: Jammu hotel (2 nights), Bhawan (1 night), twin sharing
- Helicopter tickets Katra ⇄ Sanjichhat
- Bhairon ropeway tickets
- Battery car Sanjichhat Helipad → Bhawan
- All transfers and sightseeing by private vehicle (about 136 km)
- All meals – breakfast, lunch and dinner – pure vegetarian, from Day 1 lunch to Day 4 breakfast
- Evening & Morning Atka Aarti at the Holy Cave, arranged for the group (passes as allotted by the Shrine Board)
- Assistance with RFID Yatra registration
- Tour leader and escort throughout; daily kirtan and sthala purana
- Travel insurance

NOT INCLUDED

- Flight charges to Jammu and back
- Personal offerings, shopping, tips and porterage
- Anything not listed under inclusions
- GST 5%

PACKAGE PRICE & DATES

Saturday 13 – Tuesday 16 March 2027

₹50,000 + 5% GST

per person · all-inclusive · excluding flight charges

Registrations close 25 December 2026. Limited seats (helicopter quota).

Call **95053 88886** to book.

FLIGHT INFO · PLEASE BOOK ACCORDINGLY

- Arrive Jammu Airport: Sat 13 Mar 2027, before 2 pm
- Depart Jammu Airport: Tue 16 Mar 2027, after 2 pm

MEAL PLAN · PURE VEGETARIAN

Day 1	LUNCH	15:15–15:50	Hotel restaurant, Jammu
Day 1	DINNER	20:15–21:15	Hotel restaurant, Jammu
Day 2	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	Hotel restaurant, Jammu
Day 2	LUNCH	13:30–14:15	Restaurant, Bhawan
Day 2	DINNER	19:30–20:30	Restaurant, Bhawan
Day 3	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	Restaurant, Bhawan
Day 3	LUNCH	12:40–13:30	Pooja Vaishno Dhaba, Katra
Day 3	DINNER	20:00–21:00	Hotel restaurant, Jammu
Day 4	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	Hotel restaurant, Jammu

How we are *different*

1 Sattvic food
Pure-vegetarian meals planned for every day; no onion-garlic on request

2 Pre-approved stays
Hotels checked and approved by Punya Kshetras, not booked blind

3 Comfortable transport
Clean, well-kept vehicles with experienced hill drivers

4 Care for seniors
Escorts on the track, battery car to Bhawan, unhurried pace

5 Narration by devotees
Sthala purana and the glories of each holy place, in Telugu, Hindi and English

6 Family-like yatra
Kirtan, japa and satsang every day with ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees

7 No hidden charges
All-inclusive: stays, meals, helicopter, ropeway, gondola and transfers in one clear package price

CURATED SPECIAL EXPERIENCES

- Melodious bhajans & kirtans
- Sthala purana narrations
- Comfortable stay
- Relaxed itinerary
- Special care for seniors
- Sattvic food



Moments from our past yatras


Devotees on yatra with Punya Kshetras

PACK THESE

- Original photo ID + copy
- Small day bag for Bhawan
- Shawl / light jacket
- Walking shoes with grip
- Personal medicines
- Raincoat or umbrella
- Postpaid SIM, power bank

DO'S

- Carry original photo ID at all times
- Keep the RFID Yatra card with you from Katra
- Report 10 minutes before every departure
- Stay with your buddy; wear the group scarf
- Use cloak rooms before darshan
- Keep your battery-car and helicopter slots with the group

DON'TS

- No phones, cameras or leather goods in darshan areas
- No extra baggage on the helicopter
- Don't rely on prepaid SIMs from outside J&K
- Don't buy prasad from touts
- Don't wear new shoes
- Don't leave the group without telling the leader

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Who can join?

Anyone in reasonable health. Seniors are welcome; the 2.5 km from Sanjichhat Helipad to Bhawan is covered by battery car.

What ID do I need?

Original Aadhaar or passport for every yatri, including for the RFID Yatra card at Katra and for flights.

Will my phone work?

Prepaid SIMs from outside Jammu & Kashmir do not work there. Carry a postpaid connection; our team carries postpaid phones.

What food is served?

Pure-vegetarian meals throughout; no onion-garlic food on request.

How long is the helicopter flight?

About 5–8 minutes from Katra to Sanjichhat; Bhawan is a further 2.5 km by battery car.

What if the helicopter cannot fly?

Flights depend on weather. Our team will arrange the next available slot or the best alternative; any extra costs caused by weather are borne by the yatris.

BOOKING & PAYMENT

Seats are confirmed only after the advance is received. Full and final payment is due before departure; yatris cannot join the tour otherwise. We accept bank transfer, UPI, cheque and cash; card payments carry 2% extra.

CANCELLATION BY YATRI

Requests must be sent in writing to connect@hkmhyderabad.org. More than 45 days before travel: 30% of tour cost retained, 70% refunded. 45 to 30 days: 50% retained. Less than 30 days, no-show, or after the tour starts: no refund. Refunds are paid after 30 days of cancellation.

RESCHEDULING

Allowed once, subject to availability, on payment of 10% of the tour cost, if requested at least 7 days before travel. Later requests are treated as a cancellation.

HELICOPTER & WEATHER

Helicopter services to Sanjichhat are run under Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board rules and depend on weather. If a flight is cancelled or delayed, our team will arrange the best alternative (next slot or the track). Extra stay, food or transport caused by weather, technical reasons or government orders is borne by the yatris.

BAGGAGE

Only a small hand bag is allowed on the helicopter; the main luggage waits in the vehicle or hotel. Yatris must declare their correct weight at booking.

MEDICAL

Please tell us about any medical condition or special need at the time of booking. Consult your doctor before the yatra. Punya Kshetras is not liable for medical emergencies; evacuation costs are borne by the yatri.

GOVERNMENT LEVIES

Any increase in taxes, temple or government charges after booking is payable by the yatris before departure.

CONDUCT

We may cancel the participation of any yatri who is unruly, intoxicated or unsafe to travel, without refund.

CANCELLATION BY US

If we cancel the yatra, the amount paid is refunded in full; no compensation is payable for consequential loss.

DISPUTES

Subject to the jurisdiction of courts in Hyderabad, Telangana. Booking implies acceptance of these terms.

WHO JOINED OUR YATRAS



Hare Krishna Golden Temple

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

Pilgrimage is reconnection with God

For details & registration

Please contact any temple devotee you are in touch with, or

95053 88886

booking@punyakshetras.com

www.punyakshetras.com · www.hkmhyderabad.org

Facebook · Instagram · YouTube · X: @punyakshetras · HareKrishnaGoldenTemple

Swayambhu Sri Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Kshetram, Road #12, near Anti Corruption Bureau office, NBT Nagar, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad, Telangana 500034

Jai Mata Di!

Photo credits (Wikimedia Commons, used under their licences): Banganga (Shri Mata Vaishno Devi) – Thenipunanand, CC BY-SA 4.0; Houses and Shops located in Katra, Jammu and Kashmir – Anubhav Sinha, CC BY-SA 2.0; Sanji Chhat helipad vaishno devi – Mabhishek84, CC BY-SA 3.0; Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan, Katra Jammu & Kashmir INDIA – KDhruv406, CC BY 4.0; The Temples of Raghunath, Jammu, India, ca.1875-ca.1940 (imp-cswc-GB-237-CSWC47-LS10-011) – Unknown author, Public domain; Trikuta Mountains – KuShahrukh Tendulkar, CC BY-SA 4.0; Vaishno Devi Bhavan – Abhishek Chandra, Public domain; Vaishno Devi Bhawan – Raulcaeser, CC BY-SA 3.0; Vaishno Devi entrance – Thenerdatul, CC BY 4.0. Srila Prabhupada photographs and past-yatra photos © Hare Krishna Golden Temple / respective owners.